



**MINUTES OF THE AUTOMOTIVE (MOBILITY) SECTOR STAKEHOLDER
ENGAGEMENT ON THE INTRODUCTION OF THE DIGITAL NUMBER PLATE
SYSTEM HELD ON 18TH DECEMBER 2025 AT UMA SHOW GROUND, LUGOOGO**

MEMBERS PRESENT

No.	NAME	DESIGNATION	CONTACT
1.	Mr. Bruce Lin (Chairperson)	MD Double Q Co. Ltd	Bruce@doubleq.co.ug 0775892633
2.	Mr. Katushabe Winstone	Commissioner TR&S/ CLO MoWT	katushabew@gmail.com 0772403782
3.	Mr. Allan Ssenyondwa	Director policy, research & Advocacy UMA	directorpolicy@uma.or.ug 0784358654
4.	Mr. Emmanuel Baterigaya	Process manager MoWT	ebaterigaya@mvr.go.ug 0758307055
5.	Mr. Mugerwa Alvin	ICT MVR MoWT	amugerwa@mvr.go.ug 0779676742
6.	Mr. Benjamin Ndawula	Program officer STI-OP	benjamin.ndawula@sti.go.ug 0703458765
7.	Mr. Allan Muhumuza	Team lead mobility STI-OP	allan.muhumuza@gmail.com 0701998223
8.	Mr. Abaho Edgar Paul	Process manager MoWT	abahoed@gmail.com 0774519710
9.	Mr. Azat Akuyradov	Comms &G. Manager VGS	a.akuyradov@itms-ug.com 07696676349
10.	Mr. Damir Makhmutov	MD VGS	d.makhmutov@itms-ug.com 0789003409
11.	Mr. Nikita Novoselov	Production Director VGS(ITMS)	n.novoselov@itms-ug.com 0769676311
12.	Mr. Manjet Ramel	CEO Yuvraj international	admin@yuvrajinternational.com

		(U) Ltd	0704907877
13.	Mr. Emuria Charles	Registration Clerk DURA Motors LTD	charlesemuria@gmail.com 077268294
14.	Mr. Busingye Deon	Operations DURA Motors Ltd	deonbusingye@gmail.com 0705111022
15.	Mr. Esunget Simon	Manager customs URA	sesunget@ura.go.ug 0772140533
16.	Mr. Mukusu Barnabus	Sales DURA Motors Ltd	mukusubarnabas@gmail.com 0702242265
17.	Mr. Gordon Wavamunno	QC SPV ITMS	g.wavamunno@itms-ug.com 0703800199
18.	Mr. Tumwine Joseph	Head Installations ITMS	i.tumwine@itms-ug.com 0775083578
19.	Ms. Namutebi Grace	Administrative assistant ITMS	n.grace@itms-ug.com 0703339110
20.	Ms. Judith Q Mukasa	Secretary Spear Group	joseku@spearmotors.co.ug 0772757777
21.	CPA Hirak Bhansali	CFO Simba Automotives	cf0@simbaautomotives.com 0706295741
22.	Mr. Richard Musani	Head of marketing Double Q Co. Ltd	richardmusani@gmail.com 0782436021
23.	Ms. Lilian Nankwanga	Custom Clearance Supervisor Double Q	lilian@doubleq.co.ug 0756239375
24.	Mr. Busingye David	Executive Director Spear Group	busingyed@wavahwater.com 0788082881
25.	Mr. Luyondo Gilbert	Sales Executive DURA	0702481832
26.	Mr. William Byamugisha	Engineer MTIC	william.byamugisha@mtic.go.ug 0785587951
27.	Mr. Kayiwa Jordan Titus	Process Officer MoWT	tjkayiwa@mvr.go.ug 0704611964
28.	Mr. Micheal Kaija	Policy Officer UMA	k.micheal@uma.or.ug 0783886381
29.	Mr. Gilbert Kibekityo	Research & Policy UMA	k.gilbert@uma.or.ug

			0703842870
30.	Mr. Patrick Komakech	Policy Analyst UMA	k.patrick@uma.or.ug 0784666570
31.	Ms. Sarah Kbasinguzi K	Policy Officer UMA	0772986520
32.	Mr. Mustapha Tazenya	Policy Officer UMA	t.mustapha256@gmail.com 0705958209
33.	Mr. Akugizibwe Deogratias (Minute Secretary)	Coordinator mobility sector UMA	deoa356@gmail.com 0774126361

AGENDA.

1. Opening prayer
2. Communication from the chair
3. Remarks by Officials from Ministry of Works and Transport
4. Discussions and reactions
5. Way forward and closure.

MEETING MINUTES

#	MINUTE AND DISCUSSION	RESPONSIBILITY
1.1.	Minute 1.0: Opening prayer The chairperson asked a volunteer to lead in an opening prayer for the meeting to commence	UMA Secretariat.
2.1.	Minute 2: Communication from the chairman. The Chairman extended a warm welcome to all members present, expressing sincere appreciation for their consistent and active participation throughout the meeting and as well thanked officials from ministry of works and transport for being present at the engagement. He proceeded to provide a comprehensive update on the remarkable achievements and milestones accomplished by the Mobility Sector during the course of 2025, highlighting key progress in areas such as policy advocacy, stakeholder collaborations, and operational enhancements that have strengthened the sector's position within Uganda's manufacturing landscape.	Chairperson UMA Mobility sector

2.2:	He passionately called upon all members to maintain and indeed intensify their active engagement and contributions moving forward, emphasizing that such collective commitment remains essential to driving sustainable growth, overcoming persistent challenges, and positioning the sector for even greater success in the coming year. Remarks by Director Allan (on behalf of UMA) Director Allan extended a heartfelt welcome to all members gathered for the meeting, setting a collaborative tone for the discussions ahead. He provided comprehensive background on the persistent number plates issue, tracing its evolution and detailing the multifaceted challenges that have emerged since implementation, including bureaucratic delays, escalated costs, and operational bottlenecks affecting vehicle registration processes across regional centers. He elaborated on the profound impacts these challenges have exerted on both the broader economy through reduced revenue collections and diminished production capacities and individual businesses, citing specific examples such as prolonged delays in motorcycle financing approvals, tri-cycle sector disruptions, and losses in the oil and automotive supply chains that have collectively hampered efficiency and profitability. He reassured members that UMA remains fully committed to fostering collaboration with all stakeholders, pledging proactive engagement to develop practical solutions, streamline processes, and create an enabling environment where every business in the sector can thrive and sustain long-term profitability amidst evolving policy landscapes.	All to note
	MINUTE 3: Remarks by Officials from Ministry of Works and Transport The Commissioner for Transport Regulation and Safety from the Ministry of Works and Transport delivered comprehensive remarks, providing valuable insights into the ongoing developments surrounding the number plates system He began by offering detailed background on the origins of the number plates issue, explaining how it emerged as a critical	Ministry of Works and Transport

	response to longstanding challenges in vehicle management, registration processes, and regulatory oversight within Uganda's mobility sector, ultimately evolving into a structured government initiative to address systemic inefficiencies. The Commissioner provided broad strategic guidance and clear operational guidelines, emphasizing that this represents a deliberate policy move that received full endorsement from Cabinet, positioning it as a cornerstone of national efforts to modernize transport infrastructure and regulatory frameworks. He highlighted how various transformative projects are actively underway, all strategically designed to create an enabling environment that empowers the private sector to thrive, fosters business growth, and aligns with broader economic development goals under government priorities. The official outlined plans for mandatory vehicle registration, articulating its primary goal of cleaning up and digitizing the national mobility database to enhance accuracy, traceability, and data-driven decision-making across the sector He clarified that the new number plates system is fundamentally anchored in improving revenue collection mechanisms, curbing the misuse of vehicles through better accountability, streamlining the overall issuance process for greater efficiency, and most critically enhancing national security through advanced technological integration. To address accessibility concerns, the Commissioner informed members that numerous issuance centers are being established across upcountry regions, aimed at significantly easing the registration process, reducing turnaround times, and markedly improving service delivery for all stakeholders. He further explained that the system incorporates embedded tracking devices within the number plates themselves, enabling real-time monitoring capabilities that support security objectives without compromising operational feasibility. Reassuring the attendees, the Commissioner stressed that the new system is explicitly not intended to frustrate customers, clients, or businesses, but rather to deliver long-term benefits, with commitments to ongoing refinements that will make processes smoother and more efficient once initial challenges are rectified.	All to note
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	Finally, he noted that the implementation team operates within defined parameters, with overall control residing at the central command center, ensuring coordinated and standardized execution across all levels.	
	Minute 4: Discussions and reactions. 4.1 Response from VGS Officials (ATTACHED IS A REPORT FROM VGS) Officials from VGS, a prominent Russian company operating under Global Security with 220 dedicated employees, presented a comprehensive report addressing the operational challenges within the number plate system. They highlighted their robust production capabilities for number plates, backed by full certification and compliance with standards from the Uganda National Bureau of Standards (UNBS), ensuring quality and reliability in all outputs. To safeguard business continuity and prevent operational disruptions, they explained that the original company structure had been strategically incorporated into VGS, demonstrating proactive measures to sustain service delivery amid evolving regulatory demands. 4.2 Reactions from Dura Motors Dura Motors raised critical concerns regarding log books, noting their rampant unavailability particularly for motorcycles which poses a significant barrier to seamless vehicle transactions and ownership transfers across the sector. He emphasized severe difficulties in obtaining number plates at upcountry fitment centers, where service delivery is notoriously slow, marked by excessive waiting times, bureaucratic hurdles, and inconsistent processing that hampers daily business operations. He further identified serious challenges with knockdown procedures, transitional inefficiencies between old and new systems, and called for the introduction of batch approval mechanisms to streamline processes, reduce bottlenecks, and alleviate the cumulative impact on sector productivity. 4.3 Response from URA Representative The URA representative pinpointed vehicle registration as the core issue driving turnover delays, underscoring how these bottlenecks directly undermine revenue streams and economic contributions from the mobility sector. They stressed the urgent need for clearly delineated roles and	

	responsibilities among stakeholders to eliminate overlaps, enhance accountability, and foster smoother inter-agency coordination. Finally, they formally requested a dedicated engagement meeting focused on vehicle registration protocols to collaboratively resolve persistent challenges and align all parties toward more effective implementation.	
5.0	Minute 5: Way forward and closure. 5.1 The meeting reached a clear consensus to schedule a dedicated engagement with clearing agents from various companies, set for 29th January 2026, specifically aimed at addressing operational hurdles and charting pathways for smoother business operations across the entire mobility sector value chain. 5.2 Quarterly Engagement Commitment The Ministry of Works and Transport proposed the establishment of regular quarterly engagement sessions with UMA, designed to provide a structured platform for candid discussions on emerging sector issues, proactive problem-solving, and sustained dialogue to ensure alignment between government initiatives and private sector needs. 5.3 Process Improvements and Infrastructure Expansion The Ministry reaffirmed its commitment to comprehensively improving the number plate issuance processes, with targeted interventions to ease the ongoing transition period, eliminate bottlenecks, and significantly smoothen business operations for all stakeholders reliant on timely vehicle registration and clearance. Additionally, the Ministry pledged to accelerate the establishment of new service centers while strategically strengthening existing upcountry facilities, thereby enhancing accessibility, reducing turnaround times, and bolstering overall service delivery capacity to better support sector-wide growth and efficiency. 5.4 There being no other business, the Chairperson adjourned the meeting at 12: 30 p.m.	Ministry of Works and Transport / All to note Ministry of Works and Transport / UMA Secretariat All to note

